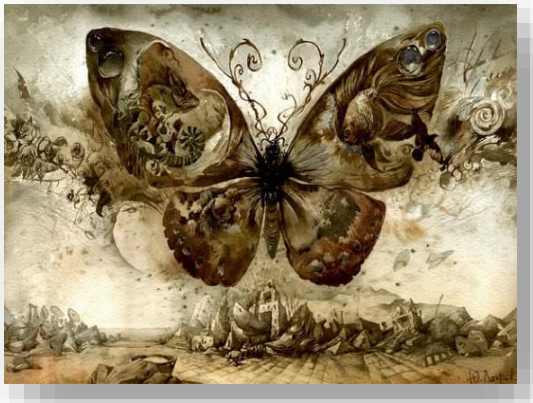
CNEAP 402 COURSEWORK ESSAY TASK SHEET, Semester 2, 2026

ELECTRONIC AND COMMUNICATIONS ENGINEERING GRP



Coursework Essay Title: *Analyse the role of IoT-enabled smart homes in China and evaluate their contribution to enhancing the quality of life of ageing populations.*

Assigned: *Week 1*

Essay Type: *Cause-Effect Academic Essay*

Weight: 30% *of your final CNEAP402 grade*

分析物联网智能家居在中国的作用，并评估其对提高老龄化人口生活质量的贡献

COURSEWORK OVERVIEW

This assignment requires you to write a cause-effect academic essay, using real-world examples drawn from Electronic and Communications Engineering. It aims to help you further develop your academic writing skills while evaluating your ability to think critically in relation to IoT-enabled smart homes in China and wellbeing in later life.

HOW YOUR ESSAY WILL BE ASSESSED

评价标准

This assignment will be assessed by the convenor of CNEAP402 according to the criteria listed below:

1. **Academic Content and Subject Knowledge** *This includes your ability to demonstrate:*
   学术内容和学科知识
   - Clear understanding and accurate application of key concepts around IoT-enabled smart homes in China
   - Depth of analysis and critical thinking
   - Relevance and clarity of examples and evidence
   - Accurate use of source material to support claims

2. **Academic English and Communication Skills** *This includes your ability to:*
   学术英语和沟通技巧
   - Express ideas clearly, fluently, and accurately in written English
   - Use appropriate academic tone and subject-specific vocabulary
   - Structure your essay with a clear introduction, main body, and conclusion
   - Organise ideas into logically developed paragraphs with clear topic sentences
   - Use effective summarising and paraphrasing techniques
   - Maintain cohesion and logical flow throughout the essay
   - Cite and reference sources correctly using Lancaster Harvard style

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF The coursework essay will address the following task:

Task Instructions

本文探讨了中国物联网智能家居发展背后的驱动因素，并评估了它们对弱势用户群体的影响。您需要在集中讨论中展示概念清晰度和批判性评估。

This essay examines the drivers behind the development of IoT-enabled smart homes in China and evaluates their impact on vulnerable user groups. You are expected to demonstrate conceptual clarity and critical evaluation within a focused discussion. Your essay should be structured to cover:

1. **Extended Definition**: The first paragraph must consist entirely of an extended definition of "IoT-enabled smart homes." Your definition should: 第一段必须完全包含"支持物联网的智能家居"的扩展定义
   - **a)** Define IoT in technical terms.
   - **b)** Identify the main components and functions of IoT-enabled smart homes.
   - **c)** Distinguish them from conventional housing.

2. **Drivers of Adoption in China:** Identify and explain key motivations for adopting IoT-enabled smart homes in China. You should focus on two or three key drivers rather than attempting to cover all possible factors. You may consider: 确定并解释在中国采用物联网智能家居的主要动机。您应该关注两个或三个关键驱动因素，而不是试图涵盖所有可能的因素
   - Demographic ageing
   - Healthcare pressures
   - National digital or smart city policies
   - Technological and industrial innovation

3. **Impact on Ageing Populations:** Evaluate how IoT-enabled smart homes influence the quality of life of elderly residents in China. Your discussion should prioritise depth of analysis by examining two or three key impacts in detail, rather than attempting to cover all possible outcomes. You may consider:
   - Independence and ageing in place
   - Safety and health monitoring
   - Caregiver burden
   - Social inclusion

评估物联网智能家居如何影响中国老年人的生活质量。您的讨论应通过详细检查两个或三个关键影响来优先考虑分析的深度，而不是试图涵盖所有可能的结果

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

The use of generative AI tools (for example ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar software) for drafting, editing, paraphrasing, idea generation, or translation is strictly prohibited.

Use of such tools will be treated as a breach of Lancaster University's academic integrity policy.

You must sign the declaration on the cover page to confirm compliance.

GENERAL GUIDELINES

Formatting Requirements 格式要求

- You must incorporate the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your essay (see page 4)
- The essay should be between 900 and 1,200 words in length (excluding any figures or tables).
- Insert page numbers at the bottom of each page.
- You should use Times New Roman or Arial font in either 11-point or 12-point size.
- Use 1.5 or double line spacing.
- The essay must be written in continuous academic prose without subheadings or bullet points.

Figures and Tables

- The inclusion of figures and/or tables is optional for this essay.
- Each figure and table should be clearly numbered and titled and must be explicitly mentioned within the paragraph (i.e. not just appear).
- Do not reproduce any figures or tables; only use them if you have adapted them and synthesised different elements.

Citation and Referencing

- Use Lancaster University Harvard referencing system as detailed on the CNEAP402 Moodle page.
- Every citation must have a corresponding reference and vice versa.
- Use summarising and paraphrasing effectively. Direct quotations should not exceed 10% of the total word count.
- You must cite a minimum of 5 high-quality academic sources in English, of which at least 3 should be peer-reviewed journal articles.

You must annotate three of your academic sources. For each selected source:

- Highlight or underline key points
- Write brief notes in the margins
- Include the annotated pages at the end of your submission

These annotated pages are not included in the word count.

Do Not (×)

- Use any bullet points
- Write paragraphs that are underdeveloped. A paragraph generally consists of 5–8 sentences that explore a topic with supporting evidence.
- Submit a report. This task must be written as a properly structured academic essay

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

- Draft Submission: Week 6 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed)
- Submit your essay as a Word document via the EAP 402 Moodle page. Submissions cannot be accepted via WeChat or email, and PDF files are not allowed.
- Final submission: Week 8 (by 23:59 on the date to be confirmed). The name of your file should be: 'Coursework Essay Final' - *your student number* - *your name in Pinyin*'
- Your submission must have the EAP402 Coursework Essay Cover Page at the beginning of your document, showing your Chinese name, English name, student number, class number, date and declaration.

Late submission penalties:

- 5% deduction: More than 24 hours late
- 10% deduction: More than 36 hours late

Note: Only medical exemptions with a valid doctor's note will be accepted.

CNEAP402: Coursework Essay Cover Page

Programme:	English for Academic Purposes – Master's Programme
Module:	EAP 402
Chinese Name:	
English Name:	
Student Number:	
Class:	
Essay Title:	
Word Count	
Date of Submission	

Declaration of Academic Integrity

I declare that this essay is entirely my own work and has been produced without the assistance of generative AI tools (including but not limited to ChatGPT, Grammarly Premium, or similar). I understand that the use of such tools violates Lancaster University's academic integrity policy and may result in academic penalties.

Signed: ……

Date: …….